CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · MEDIUM LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 2

Chapters 9–12: **The Boy Who Broke the Bank, The Visitor (from The Book Thief), Helen Keller (poem) - Langston Hughes, The Stolen Bacillus** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Medium level: multi-step questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The visitor's remark in para 5 is a hint that he: 1

(a) dislikes science
(b) is a doctor
(c) wants to know whether living bacteria are kept in the lab
(d) is a student

2. Which sentence from the story shows the speed of the rumour? 1

(a) The clerks shut down their counters.
(b) The Seth was holidaying in Kashmir.
(c) Nathu used the small broom hurriedly.
(d) The news spread through the bazaar with the rapidity of a forest fire.

3. 'Their heartbeats fought each other, a mess of rhythm' conveys: 1

(a) all were extremely tense **(b)** they were exercising
(c) they were angry at each other **(d)** they were dancing

4. Which statement about the poem's structure is correct? 1

(a) It alternates English and Hindi
(b) Each stanza is a question
(c) It has a chorus
(d) Two parallel stanzas are followed by a stanza on the world's gain

5. Which word best describes the Anarchist's thoughts in para 24? 1

(a) total calm **(b)** a mixture of fear and triumph
(c) laziness **(d)** complete sorrow

6. Choose the correct reported form: Sitaram said, 'I'll be on the lookout for a job for you.' 1

(a) Sitaram said that I would be on the lookout for a job for you.
(b) Sitaram says he would be on the lookout for you.
(c) Sitaram said that he would be on the lookout for a job for him.
(d) Sitaram said he will be on the lookout for a job for you.

7. The phrase 'Papa stood. Another idea.' shows Papa: 1

(a) was sleepy
(b) was angry
(c) had given up
(d) never stopped thinking of ways to stay safe

8. The phrase 'within herself' is an example of: 1

(a) a passive voice **(b)** a conditional
(c) a reflexive pronoun use **(d)** a past perfect

9. 'Cultivation' in this story means: 1

(a) politeness
(b) a type of crop
(c) farming
(d) a sample of bacteria grown in a lab for study

10. Why is Mrs Prakash's reaction to the news ('Oh, is that so?') significant? 1

(a) She doubts Sitaram's honesty
(b) She is deeply worried about her money
(c) She offers to help the bank
(d) She accepts a servant's complaint as news without checking it

11. By choosing to 'make it real', Liesel shows: 1

(a) carelessness **(b)** laziness
(c) careful planning under pressure **(d)** dislike of football

12. The pause after 'She,' at the start of a stanza mainly creates: 1

(a) humour **(b)** emphasis and expectation
(c) a rhyme **(d)** confusion

13. The 'slight gleam of satisfaction' on the visitor's face suggests that he: 1

(a) is afraid
(b) is bored
(c) is pleased to learn the live germs are there
(d) is relieved to find the tube dead

14. 'Imminent' in 'the imminent crash of the bank' means: 1

(a) about to happen very soon **(b)** unimportant
(c) long past **(d)** impossible

15. Papa's decision to rush to the basement door and throw a warning down shows that he: 1

(a) wanted to leave **(b)** disliked Max
(c) thought of Max first **(d)** forgot Max

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. What could have gone wrong if Papa had behaved nervously? 2

17. Explain why the poet says 'her dower'. 2

18. What is humorous about Minnie's instructions to the cabman? 2

19. Why did the writer include mischief-makers in the crowd? 2

20. Why might Papa have called, 'Everything good down there?' 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Describe the Anarchist's plan and his fears in the cab. 3

22. Convert into indirect speech: Mrs Bhushan said, 'I don't know what's happening to this town.' 3

23. Why did Papa want the family to look busy during the inspection? 3

24. Fill with the correct form and give a reason: Keller ___ (found/finds) light, and the world still ___ (receive/receives) her message. 3

OR

Pick out the details that show the story is set in London. 3

25. Why do you think Sitaram helped Nathu though Nathu had not asked him? 3

OR

Why did Liesel say 'My papa' and ask Rudy to get him? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. Write a letter to the editor of a newspaper about the dangers of spreading rumours. 5

OR

Explain how humour and fear are mixed in the inspection scene. 5

27. Write an article (about 120 words) on 'Seeing with the heart', inspired by the poem. 5

OR

What is the anticlimax in the story? Explain how it adds to its effect. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 50 Marks

MASTERMIND